

Successful Tax Preparation for New Police Recruits

PDF-Free Report -Tax preparation for New Police Recruits.

Successful Tax Preparation for New Police Recruits-2019

This guide explains how New Police recruits can get themselves organised to take control and better prepare for their tax preparation and lodgment to the ATO.



For more information go to
www.policetax.com.au

Accountants Plus Group Pty Ltd

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Successful Tax Preparation for New Police Recruits



During attendance at academy/Probationary Training

Your journey to becoming a Police Officer begins at the Academy, where you will undergo a rigorous and lengthy training and skills program. On top of this you will need to get prepared to do your first tax return as a Law Enforcement officer. We have been assisting New Police Recruits Australia wide with their taxation needs for over 43 years. Whilst the training varies from state to state academies in Australia, the tax basics are similar.

We have created this service for New Police Recruits to make life a little bit easier as we understand how stressful and busy you are with your New career.

New Police Recruits getting organized for tax (10 Handy Hints)



1. Record all the small stuff.
2. Keep track of receipts by using online tools and apps. We have our very own PoliceTax application to help you along the way.
1. iOS: <https://itunes.apple.com/au/app/policetax/id1416983647?mt=8>
2. Android: <https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=apt.accountantsplus.deakin.policetaxapp>
3. If you are still using a spreadsheet and a shoebox, it's time to upgrade.
4. Record all income that ATO has with income tracking tools.
5. Track your training car kms and don't forget your academy live-in accommodations.
6. Track your phone calls.

7. Track your dividend statements.
8. Don't forget your Police union/Association.
9. Know your work-related deductions for Police work
10. Ask Questions!

This guide will attempt to explain to a New Police recruit the steps we go through to preparing and lodging your tax. The steps are as follow:

Income from all sources

1. Recording some basic tax information and personal details
2. List your Salary for your Police role or a prior job
3. Bank interest earned/Shares or investments
4. Payments such as New start or other Government payments

Tax deductions claims

- D1-Work related Car Kms for New Police Recruits
- D2-Work related Travel & accommodation expenses for New Police Recruits
- D3-Work related Clothing and uniform expenses for New Police Recruits
- D4-Self education expenses for New Police Recruits
- D5-other work-related expenses for New Police Recruits
- D9/10 Non work-related deductions

The above deduction categories are the main ones we focus on with New Police Recruits. Investor clients might use some other deduction categories.

Other tax questions that might impact a New Police recruit

1. Private health insurance during the year Yes or No
2. Spouse or defacto during the year
3. Do you have an education debt (Heccs/Help)?

Tax returns cover the financial year from 1 July to 30 June. If you're lodging your own tax return it is due by 31 October.

What are the current tax rates?

Taxable income	Tax on this income
0 – \$18,200	Nil
\$18,201 – \$37,000	19c for each \$1 over \$18,200
\$37,001 – \$87,000	\$3,572 plus 32.5c for each \$1 over \$37,000
\$87,001 – \$180,000	\$19,822 plus 37c for each \$1 over \$87,000
\$180,001 and over	\$54,232 plus 45c for each \$1 over \$180,000

D1-Work related Car Kms for New Police Recruits

What can you claim? You can claim car expenses you incurred in performing your employment duties in 2018 –19. You can also claim the cost of using your car to travel directly between two separate places of employment when you have a second job, providing one of the places is not your home.

You cannot claim for the normal trip between home and work, unless:

- You use your car to carry bulky tools or equipment which your employer requires you to use for work and cannot leave at work
- Your home is a base for employment (you were required to start work at home and travelled to a workplace to continue work for the same employer), or
- You have shifting places of employment (you regularly work at more than one place each day)



Cents per km claims method

We normally recommend to New Police Recruits this method as it is less complicated but will still get a desirable tax result. Under this method the most you can claim is 5,000 kilometres per car, even if you travelled more.

No written evidence of expenses is necessary with this method, but you may need to be able to show how you worked out your Police work-related kilometres (for example producing diary records or these trips.)

Under the cents per kilometre method a single rate is used. Your claim is based on 68 cents per kilometre for 2018–19 income year (or 66 cents per kilometre for the 2017–18 income year).

Where you and another joint owner use the car for separate income-producing purposes, you can each claim up to a maximum of 5,000 business kilometres.

Better still is download the Police tax app from either app stores and use our exclusive kms tracker.

We have a list below of typical car travel Km examples a New Police recruit might claim under method 1 set rate per kms.



Car Travel	Police Role	PSO/PSU Role	PCO Role
Information session Undertake a medical Entrance Examination. Visits Police library Video interview psychological testing Graduation day	Claim might be subject to some ATO rules	Claim might be subject to some ATO rules	Claim might be subject to some ATO rules
Attend academy-length of time will vary	31 weeks	12 weeks	8 weeks
Panel interviews	Yes	Yes	Yes
Traffic Directing	Yes	N/A	N/A
Visiting other stations	Yes	Yes	Yes

Dedicated training station various phases	Yes	N/A	N/A
Confirmation training	Yes	Yes	N/A
Probation training	N/A	Transit HQ	N/A
Booze bus training	Yes	N/A	N/A
Driver training course	Yes	N/A	N/A
Custody training	Yes	N/A	N/A
Pistol Training & tactical training	Yes	Yes	N/A
Security Sports events	Yes	N/A	N/A
Attend leadership courses	Yes	Yes	Yes
Attend first aid/OHS course	Yes	Yes	Yes
Other	Yes	Yes	Yes
physical fitness test	Yes	Yes	N/A
Recommend the use of our Police tax phone app for Car Km Tracking available at both major app stores-just download			

D2-Work related Travel & accommodation expenses for New Police Recruits



This question is about travel expenses you incur in performing your work as an as a New Police recruit. They include:

- Can include air travel and taxi fares
- Bridge and road tolls, parking fees and short-term car hire

Meal, accommodation and incidental expenses you incur while away overnight for work and of course any live in at the academy costs(As an example, Living in at the Academy \$473.80 per fortnight Victoria only, Living in at the Academy-Other state please call us

To claim meal, accommodation and incidental expenses for Police Training or work you incurred when you travelled away overnight for work:

1. The travel must be undertaken in performing your work duties
2. You must only be working away from home for a relatively short period or periods of time (not living away from home)
3. You must not have incurred the expenses because of a choice you made about where to live
4. You must have a permanent home at a location away from the work location to which you are travelling
5. You must have paid the expenses yourself and not have been reimbursed for them.
6. If any private element of the work-related travel expenses it may need to be a pro rata claim.

D3-Work related Clothing and uniform expenses for New Police Recruits

You can claim the cost of a work uniform that is distinctive (or one that has your employer's logo permanently attached to it) and it must be either:

- a non-compulsory uniform that your Police organization requires.
- a compulsory uniform that can be a set of clothing or a single item that identifies you as an employee of any Police organisation.
- There must be a strictly enforced policy making it compulsory to wear that clothing at work. Items may include shoes, socks and jumpers where they are an essential part of a distinctive compulsory uniform and the colour, style and type



see our list of Police deductions on our website

Our main list of tax deductions under D3-Work related Clothing and uniform expenses are:

Home laundry	Repairs to uniforms	Thermals & neck warmers
Distinctive academy wear	Alterations to uniforms	Tactical Boots/Socks
Graduation day dry-cleaning	Hat, Gloves, Beanies	511 tactical pants

You can also claim the cost of:

- occupation-specific clothing which allows people to easily recognise that occupation and which are not for everyday use
- protective clothing and footwear to protect you from the risk of illness or injury, or to prevent damage to your ordinary clothes, caused by your work or work environment. proof items of clothing made with heavy duty mesh that are designed to protect you.

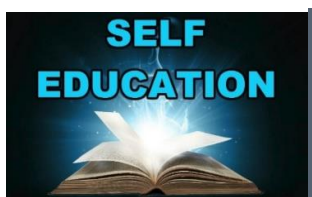
You cannot claim the cost of purchasing or cleaning plain uniforms or clothes, such as black trousers, white shirts, suits or stockings, even if your employer requires you to wear them.

D4-Self education expenses for New Police Recruits

To claim a deduction for self-education expenses, you must have met one of the following conditions when you incurred the expense:

- The course maintained or improved a skill or specific knowledge required for your then current work activities
- You could show that the course was leading to, or was likely to lead to, increased income from your then current work activities, or
- Other circumstances existed which established a direct connection between the course and your then current work activities.

You cannot claim contributions you, or the Australian Government, make under HECS-HELP or repayments you make under the Higher Education Loan Program (HELP), the Student Financial Supplement Scheme (SFSS), the Student Startup Loan (SSL)



Some of the items that New Police Recruits can claim for self-education are:

Textbooks	Stationery	Photocopying
Course fees	Folders/compendiums	Km travel for education
Crime investigation books	Calculators	Student services
Laptops	Ipad/Notebooks	Amenities fees
Repairs to items of equipment	Carry bags/back packs	Decline in value of your computer
Road policing legislation	Phone apps	Public transport fares.
Family violence refs		

D5-other work-related expenses for New Police Recruits

To claim a deduction for work-related expenses:

- you must have spent the money yourself and were not reimbursed
- by any Police Force.it must be directly related to earning your Police income.
- you must have a record to prove it.



Some of the other work-related deductions you will be able to claim on your tax:

Police Union Assoc fees	Mobile telephones	Torches
Training courses	Internet for work/study	Sunscreen
Entrance exam & eBook	Depreciation computers	Hand sanitizer
Classroom stationary	First Aid Certificate	Sunglasses
Home office costs	Police Magazines	Vest/Tactical watch
Additional study at night	Police journals	Multitools/
Meal expenses ATO* rules	USB disks/Hard Drives	First aid kits
Tactical gear/holders	Cameras & equipment	Fitness see at rules
Duty Kit bag & contents	Voice recorders	Road safety items
• A more extensive tax checklist can be downloaded from our home page web site (footer orange button)		Free Tax Checklist

These are only some of the other work-related items you will be able to claim on your tax as a New Police Recruit, we have an extensive checklist of over 600 items when you use our exclusive occupation specific Police tax service.

More tax-deductible claims to consider for New Police Recruits

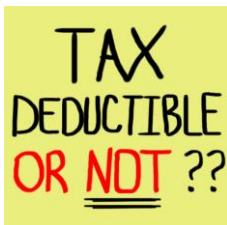
There are a few other items that you can claim on your tax as a New Police recruit that are not directly work-related items



Charities or Donations to registered charities
Contributions to Police legacy funds for fallen or injured officers
Tax agent fees paid in prior financial year
Income protection

What's no tax deductible for New Police Recruits

Some items that are of a private nature.



Grooming/haircuts	Makeup	General meals
Kms from home to work	Carparking at work	Against some allowances
Travel not work related	Tolls going to and from work	
Food/supplements	Suits or shirts/Plain clothes	Non distinctive wear
Graduation Photos	General self-education	Gym memberships*
Self educ. Paid on Hecs	Equipment provided by your Police employer	Expenses of a private nature
Cannot claim against government assistance payments, including Austudy, ABSTUDY and youth allowance		

- ATO rules apply

ATO Substantiation rules for New Police Recruits

A deduction is ONLY normally allowable if an expense meets ALL of the following tests: -

1. The expense was actually “incurred” before the end of the income year;
2. The expense meets the deductibility/nexus tests –that is, it was incurred in deriving the taxpayer’s current income and it was not private, domestic or capital in nature; and
3. The taxpayer can satisfy the stringent substantiation rules –that is, the taxpayer has written evidence of the expense incurred (if required).



Why New Recruits should not risk ATO MyGov tax online

You should consider using a professional tax service that understands your New job. Disadvantages of using Mytax:

- You are on your own, dealing with the ATO
- Doesn't help you much with deductions
- You have to use the government's myGov tax portal and enter all your details there
- The ATO's job is to collect taxes, not boost your refund



see tax shock MyGov
report on our website



Our services for New Police Recruits

We have put in a lot of effort and work to bring New Police Recruits the best possible tax service to help you get along with your career. See our service and solutions list below



Service description	Other Solutions
In person appointment at our Melbourne office	Multi years late tax
Skype tax returns for interstate Police Recruits and regional areas	Fixing past poor refunds
Online specialist tax package for New Recruits	Rental property specialists
Email tax on our supplied forms	Other Family members
Mobile Phone app tax	Group tax sessions

See our flyers

Attached is our New recruit flyer for you to distribute to your squad members to use our services.



New Police Recruits book online

Book face to face or Skype tax appointments using our cloud diary



New Police Recruits Tax deduction checklist

Get our tax checklist from our home page footer (orange button for download)



Bulk squad discounts

Group discounts for New Police Recruits in a squad starting from 10%.

Bulk discounts apply to groups of squad members wishing to have their tax preparation done by the experts at Police Tax. (1st Year Only then normal fees apply)

You will receive a discount percentage off depending on the level of squad members registered on line with us.



Schedule of discount for New Police group squad members

More than 3 and up to 9 squad members group registration.	
More than 10 and up to 19 squad members group registration.	
More than 20 Plus squad members group registration.	
These discounts* apply to all our usual prices listed on our web site.	

A note from our CEO

New Police Recruits

“When I meet New Police Recruits, I am constantly reminded how little they know about their Police academy tax claims. It amounts to thousands of dollars of tax refunds. Don’t miss out.”



Garry Angus -CEO

B Bus, Dip (Bus Admin), F.M.T.A

Get in contact with us

Call us now 1800 819 692

Let's do tax

Contact us, our friendly staff will be more than happy to provide you more information to better assist you in your quest to get the best possible tax refund for your New career.

Looking forward to hearing from you and your association.

Good Luck with your new career.



www.Policetax.com.au

END OF REPORT